

Wireless Electric Vehicle Charger

Google to install a wireless electric vehicle charging system from plugless power

Gaming Powerhouse

MSI's GX680 laptop houses GeForce GT 555M graphics solution and upto 16 GB DDR3 RAM

usage also hovered around 80MB which was quite a lot.

Just like Avira, G Data also took over 10 minutes to scan the 8 GB assorted file.

BitDefender has the worst installation process among all the suites we tested. If you make users go through 7-8 steps of clicking while installing a suite, then we feel the installer needs a lot of catching up to do as most of the other suites are simple one-click installations. And that is how it should be.

TrustPort Total took over 30 minutes to scan the 8GB assorted folder. To say that this was long, is an understatement. While scanning we noticed that the CPU usage was consistently at 80-100 per cent most of the time, and went below 10 per cent for half a minute and then resumed its peak usage. Memory consumption was always under 10MB even on load which was good. Overall, the performance does not really impress us as far as scanning the system goes.

ESET runs very light on the system, keeping the memory usage around 5-7 MB while scanning. Yes,

that is quite low memory usage indeed.

Installation was fastest with Norton and eScan suites taking around 50 seconds on our system. AVG and BitDefender took quite a while to load.

As the scanning involves use of system resources, we decided to stress the system with CPU intensive tasks and noted the difference in performance. eScan suite had minimal effect on DivX encoding with a difference of just two seconds. India Anti-virus was the worst when it came to encoding with a system scan running in the background, thanks to its memory usage of around 150 MB on load.

Cinebench R10 performance was also hit the most when TrustPort scan was running in the background. McAfee had the least effect on Cinebench R10 scores.

Flagging of links by default was enabled in only a handful of suites and the ones which had it supported only Internet Explorer and Firefox browsers.

In the user survey that we carried out, where we asked respondents to rate security



Kaspersky security solutions topped the user average scores in the Digit Security Survey

HOW WE TESTED

Security suite testing is never really accurate. Most labs will throw a virus and spyware bank at the suite and test them for accuracy. However, once a virus is detected, its signature and attack pattern is recognised, and AV updates released. It may take a few days at max, but this knowledge then permeates to all security companies, and almost all security suites can then catch that particular virus. We have an advantage over most labs, YOU. We ran a survey instead, and tens of thousands of you responded. This helped us collect data about your experiences with your security suite and how safe you've been when using it. Your ratings are what we used to determine detection and failure rates of the security suites. To test system loads, we used a modest real-world system comprising an AMD Athlon X2 processor (3 GHz), 2 GB RAM running Windows 7 Ultimate Edition.

Suites were tested for their features. We noted the time taken to install the suite, ease of installation, time taken to scan an 8 GB assorted file on our HDD and also the memory used when idle and scanning. Instead of just noting CPU usage when scanning, we did a more real world test, and ran CPU intensive tasks whilst scanning the system. We ran a DivX Encoding test and a Cinebench R10 rendering, and noted the difference in performance scores.

Ease of use was also scored for all the suites, as that is an important deciding factor with security suites. Brands who offer any free standalone products for home users were awarded extra points in the features section. Finally, we also scored the customer support methods that each brand offers.

suites based on a range of parameters, Kaspersky came out tops with a user rating of 6.52, followed very closely by Norton's solutions with 6.47 and Quick Heal with 6.4. G Data had the least score.

In terms of popularity, as expected, Avast was at the top with 18.1 per cent followed by Kaspersky at 13.57 per cent. Norton came in fourth. This can be attributed to the fact Avast provides a free anti-virus solution on its site. Only other suites also offering a free anti-virus solution were AVG and Avira.

Verdict

Apart from the obvious outliers, it was a very closely fought battle. The top three performers namely Avast, Norton and eScan were within breathing distance of

each other, but the **Best Performer** had to go to **Avast! Internet Security 6**, as it was the quickest at scanning and used the least memory on load among the three. **TrustPort Total Security 2011** with its pricing close to ₹600 won the **Best Buy** as all the other products were priced above a grand except India Antivirus's Net Protector.

Norton 360 was awarded the **Editor's Pick** as it had an overall score which was very close to that of Avast. Moreover, in terms of usability, the depth and sheer number of features provided, it clearly rolled over all the other suites and all this at an economical pricing of ₹1794.

So go ahead, give your PC that shield from malicious softwares, as its better to be safe than sorry. **d**